the marine environment, as well as of assistance and salvage measures, so that appropriate action may be taken. 2.3.1 When required: The Plan should provide clear, concise guidance to enable the master to determine when areport to the coastal State is required. 2.3.1.1 Actual discharge: Areport to the nearest coastal State is required whenever there is: . 1 adischarge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of aship or saving life at sea; or - whenever there is: . 1 adischarge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of aship or saving life at sea; or .2 adischarge during the operation of the ship of oil in excess of the quantity or instantaneous rate permitted under the present Convention. 2.3.1.2 Probable discharge: The Plan should give the master guidance to evaluate asituation which, though not involving an actual discharge, would qualify as aprobable discharge and thus require areport. In jUdging whether there is such aprobability and whether the report should be made, the following factors, as aminimwn, should be taken into account: .1 the nature of the damage, failure or breakdown of the ship, machinery or equipment; . 2 ship location and proximity to land or other navigational hazards; . 3 weather, tide, current and sea state; and .4 traffic density. 2.3.1.2.1 It is impracticable to lay down pr